



Bernventures

Check out these really cool and timely collectibles in the Bernventures series. <http://dgit.in/may21-74>



Gerontocracy

The last time we had a bunch of old people in the government, the youth had a revolution. <http://dgit.in/may21-75>

for a rapid evolution of how war is waged, leading to a scenario known as hyperwar. Already there are drone swarms that engage in coordinated exercises, underwater unnamed vehicles with the potential of carrying megatons worth of weaponised payloads, and autonomous blimps that can provide patrolling and surveillance capabilities along remote sections of national borders. In all these use cases, it is likely that lethal autonomous weapons systems are going to come into contact with non-combatants. The proliferation and development of these new technologies are expected to fundamentally change what wars look like, and introduce new risks for the safety of humans. After the world wars, the global powers came together to formulate certain new ground rules on how prisoners of war are to be treated, the use of chemical, biological and nuclear weapons, weaponising outer space, and the use of land-mines. These treaties are designed to prevent countries from engaging in unnecessary bloodshed, and to solve problems before it reaches the scales of death and destruction in the previous world wars. The problem is that there are no global treaties for use of AI in military applications. The US National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence advised the US government that there is not nearly enough funds being allocated to research and development in AI, and that there was a very real danger that Chinese advancements may leave the world behind. Considering the risk involved with this scenario, experts warn that the time is right to negotiate a global treaty on AI will be used in weapons and for warfare.



DARK PATTERNS

A dark pattern is a confusing user interface that enables a software, app or service make you do what it wants you to do instead of what you want to do. It may be something as innocuous as a preselected option on a form

but can be more malicious such as multiple download buttons, a pop up with a cancel icon and a close button, or browser addons that get you to agree to something other than what you signed up for. Other examples of dark patterns include ecommerce websites that push you towards buying stuff you didn't plan on, misleading popups, obtuse subscription services that are hard to cancel, or telecom services that charge for unnecessary additions. Darkpatterns.org tracks notorious examples of these, and even classifies them into types such as "Privacy Zuckering" where you are tricked into sharing more information about yourself than you intend to. For the first time now, there is specific legislation against dark patterns in the US state of California, where there are

NFT trading cards created a series of Bernie themed collectibles called the Bernventures. Now, Sanders has started auctioning off merchandise with a "Chairman Sanders" design, including t-shirts, pullovers, caps and stickers, all of which sold out within hours of being listed. The merch was meant specifically for raising money for charities in Sanders' home state of Vermont, and they managed to raise USD 1.8 million after selling out. You know what would fetch a pretty price at the auction? The mittens themselves.



GERONTOCRACY

Speaking of Bernie Sanders, there seem to be too many old people in the government, which is when you are left with a gerontocracy. Although the term



Bernventures collectible NFTs

regulations on how "Right to Opt-Out of Sale of Personal Information" is presented to the end users. What this means that only the privacy Zuckering variety of dark patterns are banned, and all the others are still fair game.



BERNIE SANDERS MITTENS

This meme seems to be the chosen one, because everything seems to be happening to it. The photo went viral in January, a memorable highlight of the inauguration. The image spread like a fire through social networks, spawning a market for both the same kind of jacket, as well as the mittens, which were made by a teacher. Almost immediately, Topps Digital that makes

may have been popularised recently because of American presidents it was coined in 19th century France, before the revolution. Both English and French political writers and commentators used the word to describe their parliaments, which were occupied by older politicians. These writers heavily criticised what they considered to be both a plutocracy and a gerontocracy, that was primarily invested in consolidating their own power, and holding the people under their subjugation. The underlying idea though, is even older, and goes all the way back to ancient Greece, where it was almost a law because Plato said "it is for the elder man to rule and for the younger to submit". We all know what a stinky meanie Plato was. 